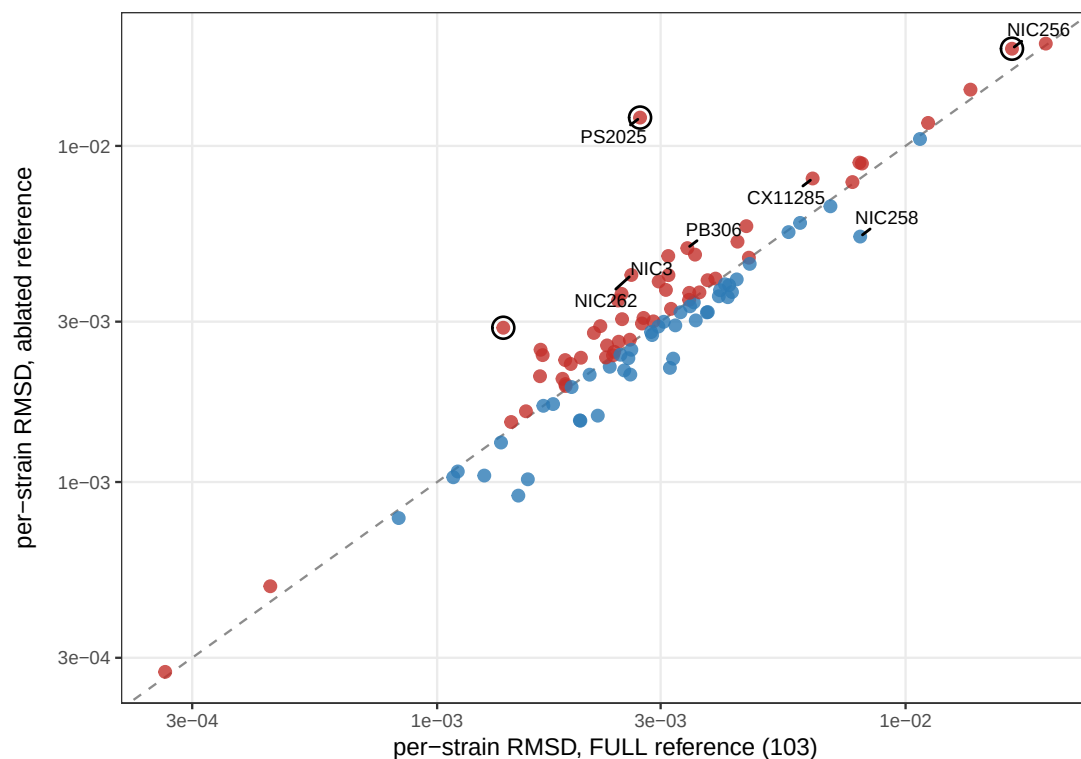


A Drop the 3 non-pool strains

Above the line = that strain got WORSE when the 3 were removed. Circled: the 3 near-twins.

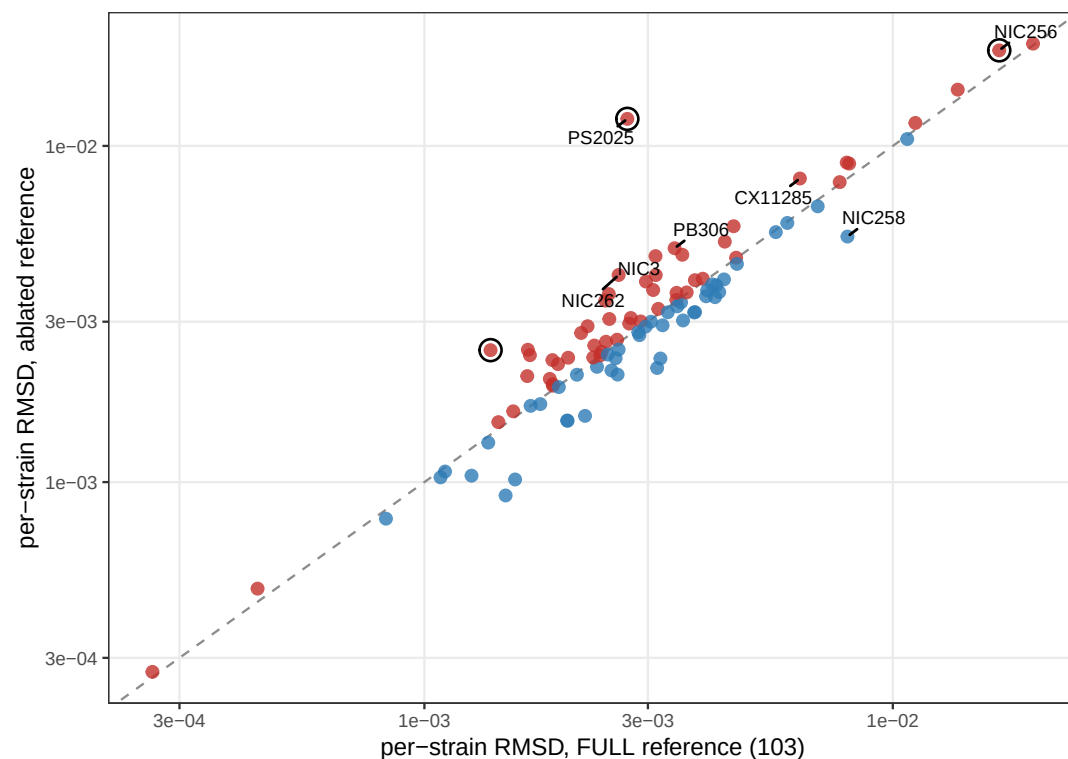
● better without ● worse without



B Negative control: 3 SYNTHETIC sponges instead

IBS-matched fake twins carrying no new information. If sponging explains A, this should match it.

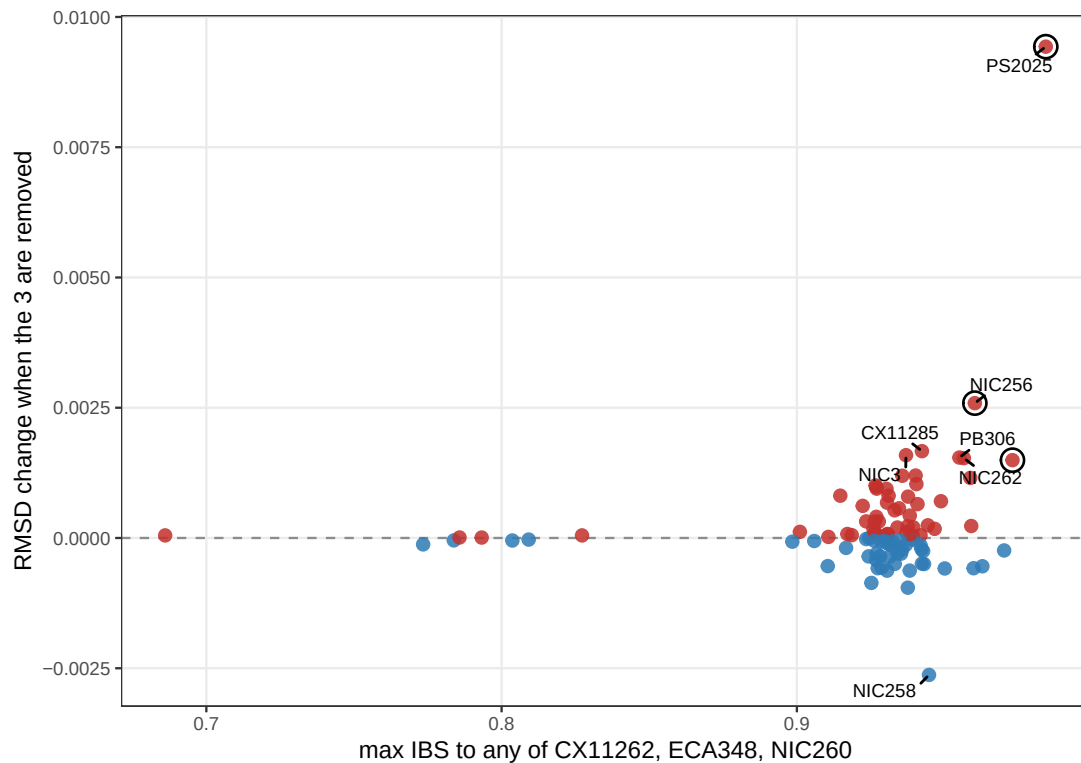
● better without ● worse without



C Change against genetic proximity to the removed strains

Spearman rho = 0.124 (p = 0.22) between max IBS to an extra and the RMSD penalty

● better without ● worse without



D Every strain across the three references

Coloured: the three near-twins of the removed strains

● CX11264 ● NIC256 ● PS2025

